

ROBERTVANWALTERINGEDIT

We are here in Amsterdam with a very interesting guest, Robert Young-Waltering. And we call him RJ for short. He's a fantastic guy.

He's the managing director of probably the most exclusive and well-known hotel here in Amsterdam, Le Europe. RJ, welcome to the program. Hi Jeff, thank you very much for having me.

I don't know if we're the most exclusive, definitely the most iconic hotel in the city of Amsterdam, located right on the river Amstel. And I'm so very blessed and fortunate to be the managing director here. Thank you for having me in your program.

Well, it's a wonderful hotel. We are just sitting here on the beautiful terrace, the private terrace, right on the water here, right on the canal. You have your own boats here, you take people out.

Just before we get into that, tell us a bit about the history of the very first ammunition storage of the city of Amsterdam. And we're talking about the very first defense wall of the city. So we're around 1250 that era, which then became obsolete because every canal in the city of Amsterdam was a new defense wall.

And it was then transformed into the very first inn of the city of Amsterdam. Now we're talking about 1398, which was then taken down, transformed into yet another hotel. And in 1896, we opened in our current form and shape as Hotel de la Rob, which was bought in the 1950s by, guess what? Sir, I should almost say, Freddie Heineken.

He bought the hotel in the 1950s. So Heineken is the owner of the hotel. We're very fortunate and blessed to have them as our owners.

They are totally proud of this hotel. And we are totally proud to have them as our owners. And of course, what else do you want to drink when you sit outside here in the sun, except a beautiful cold, freshly brewed Heineken beer? And the other thing is you have the iconic Freddie's Bar, which is one of my hangouts.

I hang out there all the time here in Amsterdam. And you have a wonderful mix of visitors, tourists, people staying at the hotel. And tell us a bit about Freddie's Bar for people who don't know about that.

So Freddie is named after Freddie Heineken who bought the hotel. It's also, it was his favorite hangout place actually used to be a direct line from that bar into his office. A private secret.

Yeah, that bar is is now I call it the coziest bar of of Amsterdam, but it's definitely a bar where you can get the best brewed beer. But besides that beautiful cocktails, the view is overlooking the Amstel River as well as the famous Mint Tower, the tower where they used to stamp the coins in around 15th, 16th century. So everything you touch here is historic.

We just renovated Freddie's Bar and we actually opened up our beautiful wine cellar for the audience, which you can book now for private tastings. And so that makes it very accessible. And it's nice to have a look at a wine cellar because it is also one of the one of the widest varieties of wines, about 1400 different references of wine.

So it's quite quite impressive, really. Now you've had some very famous people staying here at the hotel. I know a friend of mine here in Amsterdam is on the entourage of the Rolling Stones and and the guys stay here when they and sometimes they stay for extended period here and many other celebrities too.

Of course, we never talk about our guests, Jeff, but you're you're a famous man. So you're you're one of our famous guests. And no, it is, I think, by now a public knowledge that the Stones stayed here actually during the last tour for an extended period.

It was, I believe, two weeks day over at the hotel. It was sort of the preparation for the European tour. It was fun because I actually remember hosting them for the very first time in the beginning of my career in Rotterdam in another life.

So it's nice to see artists, you know, several times during your career, career in several hotels. And the hotel itself, the rooms, I've seen one of the rooms. They're just beautiful the way they're set up.

And your foyer area, it's a bit like a mini art gallery as well. Yeah, it is. We're very fortunate to have again, I mentioned it before Heineken as our owners, because we have access to their private collection of artwork.

And that's what you see now in our lobby. But the lobby is really your salon in into the city of Amsterdam, everything we do radiates Amsterdam radiates the destination. And that's what we are really we're the home of original Amsterdam luxury.

That's our baseline for the hotel and everything really we do in whether it is in our restaurants, in our bars or in the hotel. It is about the city and you can see this in our rooms. I don't know if you visited the rooms in a house at houses a bit like a canal house.

It is an extension of the hotel where we invited 14 Amsterdam creatives to come and work live and play there during COVID. And then after we professionalized those suites with individual decor design, so every suite has its own look and feel, but also its its own in house and outhouse experience. So we take you outside into the city and give you a very exclusive experience into the city of Amsterdam.

And that makes us unique in the market. We're sitting here chatting with the managing director of the fabulous Europe Hotel Robert Yarn Vultering on Travel Radio World. You have another role here in Amsterdam RJ and I hope you don't mind me calling you RJ because everyone else does

basically.

But you are very involved with the sale Amsterdam event which is coming up in August 2025. This, coinciding with the 750th anniversary of the city of Amsterdam, it's a fantastic event and tell us about it. Yeah, indeed.

Thank you for asking about that. I just entered the board for for sale Amsterdam. It's an event that happens only once every five years.

This time is the 10th version. So we celebrate Amsterdam 750 at 750th birthday of the city. The 10th version of sale.

The first one was 50 years ago. It's an event that's so special. We host, can you imagine, 25 tall ships from all over the world.

Thank God it was confirmed that our Mexican friends are coming in spite of that horrible accident that happened in New York. So Mexico will be here. We have beautiful boats from Oman from all over the world.

So that that on its own is a spectacle unheard of. But the Netherlands wouldn't be the Netherlands. We are totally into water, into canals, into all the lakes, oceans that we explored during the last few centuries.

So we got this beautiful, amazing heritage ships and there will be about 3000 of those all over the city and all over the egg lake. All the way up to the locks of a mountain. So it's going to be super spectacular.

We are expecting about two and a half million visitors over five days. So you can imagine Amsterdam is going to be one big Nordic festival. I look so much forward to it, especially having been abroad for 27 years.

So finally, again, I get to see it all and live it from A to Z. Yes. And the last one was missed out on because of COVID. So this is going to be sort of like a double celebration.

It's the double whammy. Absolutely. Yes, you're right.

We missed 2020. Terribly enough, actually. But yeah, 10 years.

So a new board, new experiences and new people. And we are very, very excited about this. Yes, it's a great event.

And I think it's shaping up to be the real party for Amsterdam for the 750. I mean, it's bigger than anything else. And we're so looking forward to covering it at Monte Carlo Digital Television and Travel Radio World as well.

Now, how can people find out more about the hotel online? Well, it's easy. You go to www.deleurope.com or www.sail.nl and you will find out all the programs, all the tall shifts. We got artists coming.

We got every night performances, usually about four to five artists a night. We got a spectacular fireworks every night. There's going to be VIPs.

There's going to be the people of Amsterdam. There's going to be you and me. And so this is a festival.

It's it's there's no entrance. So it's a free festival that anybody can visit. But obviously, it's the best from the water.

Robert Jahn, vulturing the managing director of the fabulous Delo Europe Hotel. Highly recommended for you to stay here if you are coming to Amsterdam or just to visit. You don't have to be staying here to visit Freddy's Bar or just to visit the hotel itself.

All our restaurants are made and built for the people of Amsterdam. And so that's our prime, what I call in marketing terms, my prime segment. And so every restaurant I make it for the local people and my hotel guest, of course, then I enjoy it.

And it's great because you can meet the locals. That's the beauty of Delo Europe. You meet the locals whilst being in an international environment.

And I always ask this of our guests, can you say something in Dutch for our international listeners and our Dutch friends overseas? I was actually thinking if it ain't Dutch, it ain't much, but that's not that's not very Dutch, is it? It's a welcome, a nice welcome, a nice welcome, a nice welcome to Amsterdam and a nice welcome. Thank you, Val Meneer. And thank you for being part of the program.

It's a pleasure to be here, Jeff, to all the Aussies. I look forward to welcoming you to Delo Europe. Thank you.